Writing Technique (Set B)

Year 4 · **Mark Scheme**

Lesson Worksheet — Answers

Spotting the Technique

1. C — "went" is repeated and tells the reader nothing precise about how the cat moved.
2. An adverb opener — a single adverb ("Slowly,") starts the sentence, followed by a comma.
3. C — it shows boredom through yawning and doodling instead of naming the feeling.
4. A, C, E
5. "Even so" — a contrast connective showing an unexpected result (training hard but still coming last).
6. B (snapped) — a precise verb that also conveys tone/emotion.
7. A — the short sentence "Then: a scream." lands with impact after the longer build-up.
8. Vague/overused adjectives — words that carry little precise meaning and are used too often.
9. B — "Beneath the floorboards," is a prepositional phrase opener.
10. A, C, E — these name the emotion directly rather than showing it through action/detail.
11. B — "Meanwhile" shows two events happening at the same time.
12. Any vivid, precise adjective suggesting size/menace, e.g. "enormous", "hulking", "towering", "massive".
13. Varying sentence length — the very short sentence/fragment "Silence." creates a dramatic pause.
14. "Against all odds"
15. A, C, E — these connect ideas across paragraphs; B and D are unrelated single words.

Applying the Technique

16. e.g. "Creeping along the corridor, the thief checked every door."
17. e.g. "As the sky darkened, the first drops of rain began to fall."
18. e.g. "Mia bounced on her toes, clutching the envelope so tightly it crumpled."
19. A or E (accept either) — both replace every weak word with a precise, vivid alternative.
20. e.g. "However" / "Yet" / "In spite of this"
21. Any answer giving a short dramatic sentence followed by explanatory detail, e.g. "The power went out. For three days, the whole village was left without heating, light or hot water."
22. B, C, E — each varies the opener away from repeated "He".
23. e.g. "Thunder cracked so close that the windows rattled, and the smell of rain seeped under the door."
24. C (Therefore) — shows a result of thorough revision.
25. e.g. "Hurtling down the hill, the boy sped away on his bike."
26. e.g. "The crowd fell silent. The whistle blew, and the race began." (keeping the first sentence short for effect is also acceptable)
27. "bad" → e.g. "bitter", "rancid", "stale", "revolting"
28. e.g. "However" / "By contrast" / "Nevertheless"
29. A, C, D — these vary the opener; B repeats the name and E adds a filler phrase, not true variety.
30. e.g. "The darkness pressed in from every side, swallowing the last of the torchlight. I froze."

Technique in Context

31. It creates sudden, eerie silence after the preceding noise; the abrupt short sentence contrasts with the longer sentence before it, building tension.
32. Example: 'Opening her bag, she took out her book and began reading.' (accept any valid rewrite with a varied opener)

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33. A — 'Without warning' is the fronted adverbial and 'screeched' is the strong verb.
34. It names the feeling of overwhelming quiet directly instead of letting the reader sense it. Showing version e.g.: 'No one spoke. No one moved.'
35. 'Nevertheless' — it signals a contrast, showing that the training did not stop him feeling nervous.
36. B and C (both actively avoid repetition; A and D describe the repetition problem itself).
37. Example: 'My stomach churned and my hands trembled as I waited.' (accept any valid rewrite showing the feeling through detail)
38. A — it begins with the -ing clause 'Gripping the rail tightly'.
39. Example: 'The bell rang. Everyone rushed for the door, and some pushed.' (accept any clear two-sentence rewrite)
40. It lets the reader experience or infer the emotion through actions and detail, which is more vivid and engaging than just stating the feeling.
41. A and C (each replaces a vague verb with a precise, vivid alternative; B and D use the weaker word).
42. Any two of: a fronted adverbial (e.g. 'Moments later, ...'), an -ing opener (e.g. 'Running forward, ...'), an adverb opener (e.g. 'Suddenly, ...').
43. Metaphor/personification — hope is compared to a small, fragile flame that can easily go out, suggesting her hope was fading.
44. B) However — it signals an unexpected, contrasting result.
45. Example: 'Shadows stretched across the room and every creak made my heart race. I froze.' (accept any valid pair)

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Homework Worksheet — Answers

Quick Practice

1. B — "Without a sound," is a prepositional phrase opener.
2. e.g. "crept", "tiptoed", "slunk", "edged"
3. C — it shows the sadness through physical detail (brimming eyes, staring at the floor).
4. A, C, E
5. "nice" → e.g. "glorious", "mild", "crisp" ("good" may also be flagged with a precise replacement).
6. It creates sudden drama and impact, mimicking the abruptness of the noise and grabbing the reader's attention immediately.
7. C (As a result) — shows the lateness was a consequence of missing the bus.
8. e.g. "bolted", "sprinted", "tore", "hurtled"
9. A, C, E — each has a comma after the fronted adverbial phrase.
10. "big"
11. C — it shows excitement through repeated checking/packing rather than naming the feeling.
12. B (Consequently) — shows the school closure was a result of the heavy snow.
13. e.g. "Crashing against the rocks, the waves sent spray high into the air."
14. A, C, E — precise, vivid verbs rather than vague ones.
15. "Nevertheless" — shows contrast between the museum closing soon and Grandad's insistence on seeing everything anyway.

Mixed Practice

16. e.g. "He slammed his fist on the table and glared at the wall."
17. e.g. "The team trained hard all season; however, they lost the final."
18. B — varies the opener with an -ing clause and avoids repeating the subject's name three times.
19. e.g. "The rich smell of garlic and herbs filled the kitchen, and the first bite melted in my mouth."
20. A, C, E
21. "got" → e.g. "seized", "claimed", "lifted"; "put" → e.g. "placed", "set" (improving at least one is sufficient).
22. e.g. "At the stroke of midnight, the fireworks lit up the sky."
23. B (Similarly) — shows the comparison between owls and cats.
24. e.g. "Pens tapped against desks and eyes drifted again and again towards the clock."
25. A, C, E
26. e.g. "Thunder exploded overhead, rattling the windows in their frames."
27. Current opener: an adverb opener ("Carefully,"). Rewrite e.g. with an -ing opener: "Lifting the sleeping kitten with great care, Noah held his breath."
28. A — combines the strong verb "devoured" with the cohesive device "consequently".
29. e.g. "My legs ached and my eyelids grew heavier with every step. Exhausted."
30. A, C, E

Standard / Advanced

31. Adverb opener — it begins with the adverb 'Carefully'.
32. Example: 'whispered' / 'murmured' (any verb suggesting a quiet voice).
33. C — it shows the fear through a physical action instead of naming the feeling.
34. 'Nevertheless' — it shows a contrast between the rain and the match still happening.
35. Example: 'Without warning, the fireworks lit up the sky.' (accept any valid fronted adverbial with a correct capital letter)

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36. Example: 'He slammed his fist on the table.' (accept any valid showing rewrite)
37. A, C and D (each uses contrasting sentence length deliberately; B uses no variation).
38. B) Consequently — it signals that the school closing was a result of the snow.
39. 'got' is vague; a stronger choice could be 'received' or 'lifted': "She lifted the trophy and placed it on the shelf."
40. Example: 'The dog sprinted across the garden, barking and leaping with excitement.' (accept any valid combined rewrite with a strong verb)
41. Adverb opener. Rewrite example: 'Without a sound, Noah closed the door.' (a prepositional phrase opener, or any different valid opener type)
42. A — 'devoured' is the strong verb and 'consequently' is the cohesive device linking the cause and result.
43. Example: 'My legs ached and my eyelids grew heavy. I was done.' (accept any valid pair)
44. A, C and D ('nice', 'good' and 'big' are vague and overused; 'shimmering' is already precise).
45. A short ending sentence abruptly slows the pace and creates a sense of shock or finality, which mirrors the suddenness of the event.

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